



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://trinitychristianidaho.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinity Classical Christian School Idaho (Id 83211) presents a robust classical Christian program embedded in a theologically grounded framework. Public-facing materials emphasize formation of character through faith-integrated, liberal-arts education, a clear commitment to the Great Books tradition, and explicit Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric), including Latin and Greek study. The school also foregrounds a community-oriented pedagogy (lower vs. upper school structures, Socratic dialogue, thesis projects), a clearly defined mission of forming virtue and wisdom, and proactive parental partnership (admissions, volunteer expectations, parent education). Taken together, these signals align strongly with the classical educational rubric, especially in its emphasis on formation, transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty), the liberal arts framework, and the integration of faith with reason.

Overall classification: **CLASSICAL**.

Key insights:

- The school presents a mission of formation (not mere information) rooted in Christ and Scripture, with explicit attention to virtue, wisdom, and the cultivation of character. This maps directly onto the core trinity of classical education emphasized in the knowledge base. Evidence includes statements about formation, Great Books, and a Christian worldview integrated into all disciplines.
- The curriculum is deliberately liberal-arts oriented, foregrounding the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), the Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin and Greek, and a history of Western civilization integrated across subjects. This is reinforced by explicit notes about paideia, memory work (songs/chanting), and a three-stage model of learning.
- Pedagogy in practice includes both contemplative/remembership (lower school songs/chanting) and Socratic/seminar-based discourse (upper school rhetoric and thesis projects), signaling alignment with classical methods. House system further demonstrates a virtue-formation orientation and community-building.
- Family/parent involvement is positioned as a partnership (co-teachers, volunteer opportunities, parental education), which supports the classical education ideal of shared formation between home and school.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence

- Mission emphasizes forming students in Christ, integrating faith and reason, with formation as the goal of education.

- Clear Christ-centered language, including Scripture as a foundation and a Statement of Faith; association with classical Christian education.
- The school stresses a Christian worldview and biblical truth as central in all learning, including references to Scripture and theology.
- The curriculum includes theological framing (Bible/Scripture) and a named theology educator in the upper school, reinforcing a theologically grounded pedagogy.
- Public materials frame the school as Christ-centered and the Bible as authority in education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered; Bible; Scripture; Statement of Faith; Christian worldview; theology; Soli Deo Gloria (motto). Approximately 6–8 core terms appear across sources.
- Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials.

Why this rating

- The materials consistently foreground theology, biblical authority, and Christ-centered formation as foundational to the school's mission and daily practice, with explicit theology-focused content and language. This strongly supports a CLASSICAL rating in this category, consistent with the Six Essential Elements emphasis on transcendentals and theological grounding.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school states the goal is formation and virtue, not just information or job preparedness.
- It explicitly frames truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, guiding educational aims.
- The program notes emphasize formation of character, wisdom, and virtue, aligning with Great Books and Western civilizational inquiry through a Christian lens.
- Six documented graduate goals include virtue, mature character, language mastery, broad exposure to Great Books, and an established aesthetic.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; character; truth; goodness; beauty; Great Books; Great Conversation; human flourishing; moral imagination; classical tradition; love of learning; imagination; Scripture-based worldview.
- Negative keywords present: None detected.

Why this rating

- The stated aims center on formation of the person (body, mind, soul) and virtue, with an explicit appeal to transcendentals and the Great Books tradition, which aligns with CLASSICAL criteria for purpose and goal.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Curriculum emphasizes the liberal arts framework: grammar, logic, rhetoric; the inclusion of the Quadrivium; and an integrated humanities approach. Paideia language is used to describe the educational aim.
- Great Books/Great Conversation is a central feature; students read great books and engage in Socratic-style discussions in the upper grades.
- Latin study begins in the 3rd grade; Greek in later grades; language study is integrated with Biblical/theological study and classical texts.
- History is woven throughout the curriculum; emphasis on Western civilization and sacred tradition; integration of theology with disciplines.

- Evidence of a structured, multi-year sequence (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and thesis projects in the upper school.
- “Recovering the Lost Tools of Learning” recommended to parents, signaling alignment with classical pedagogical philosophy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy); Great Books; Great Conversation; Liberal education; integration; paideia; Latin; New Testament Greek; history-of-Western-civilization; sacred tradition; thesis projects.
- Negative keywords present: None clearly evident.

Why this rating

- The explicit articulation of the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, and integrated humanities, plus language study and a clearly staged pedagogy, squarely fits the Curriculum criteria of a classical program.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Pedagogical approach includes a three-stage trilingual/linguistic progression (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) with explicit Socratic discussion in the upper grades and thesis-based rhetoric in the high school.
- Lower grades include singing, chanting, memory work; upper grades emphasize Socratic dialogue, seminars, debates, and rhetoric.
- The House System is described as forming community, mentorship, leadership, and character—aligned with virtue-teaching pedagogy.
- The programming includes classical methods that integrate faith with reason, as well as cross-disciplinary reading of the Great Books within a theological framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar; logic; rhetoric; Socratic dialogue; seminars; debates; thesis; memory/chanting; Great Books; interdisciplinary/harmony of subjects; formation; virtue; character; education as paideia; house system (community-based pedagogy).
- Negative keywords present: None clearly evident in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The school's pedagogy displays explicit classical methods (Socratic discourse in upper grades, rhetoric training, memory work, and a structured Trivium progression) along with communal/ritualized practices (house system) that support formation. This aligns with CLASSICAL pedagogy expectations.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty are described as capable, with teachers who love their subjects and are integral to the school's living curriculum; senior faculty profiles (e.g., upper-school theology) are presented; house leadership relies on faculty mentorship.
- The system emphasizes teachers as mentors and the living curriculum; examples of teacher profiles and content in upper-school theology and history are visible.
- The school communicates a culture of virtuous pedagogy and a collaborative faculty environment, with staff who deeply engage in the classical Christian vision.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum; model teachers; mentors; faculty as core; teachers as sympathetic colleagues; portrait of teacher/student ideals; faculty leadership.

- Negative keywords present: None evident.

Why this rating

- The public-facing materials emphasize a positive, virtuous, and collaborative faculty culture, with teachers depicted as central to the curriculum. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school describes a true partnership with families; parent involvement is expected (volunteering, active participation), and there is explicit language about parents as co-teachers with the school.
- Materials indicate ongoing education for parents about classical education (e.g., references to Recovering the Lost Tools of Learning and parental formation).
- Admissions emphasize parent interviews and alignment with the school's biblical philosophy; there is a clear process that requires parental understanding and involvement.
- The site communicates openness to visits and involvement from parents (e.g., "Visitors are welcome" and "parents can visit anytime" in home-state materials).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parental involvement; co-teachers; parent education; home-school linkage; active volunteering; community of learners; school-parent collaboration.
- Negative keywords present: None.

Why this rating

- The school presents a robust, explicit partnership with parents and a commitment to educating parents about classical education, which is central to the Parents & Community criterion in the classical rubric.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, Trinity Classical Christian School Idaho demonstrates a coherent classical framework across all six categories, anchored in theology, virtue formation, the Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum, the Great Books tradition, Socratic/Rhetorical pedagogy, a living-faculty model, and strong parental/community partnership.

What Would Move the Needle

- If a desire existed to push toward a pure, canonical CLASSICAL standard across all options, minor enhancements could include explicit, named liturgical/community worship practices in daily routines (beyond faith integration), and more transparent, published mappings of specific Great Books selections and correlating liberal-arts connections across grade levels to further demonstrate the Great Conversation framework to external reviewers. However, given the current public materials, these are not necessary to achieve CLASSICAL status; they would serve to strengthen the narrative for outsiders seeking deeper confirmation of the Great Books/Scholé tradition.
- For schools seeking to move from CLASSICAL toward an even more explicit "Fully Classical" identity, consider:
 - Publishing a formal, grade-by-grade Great Books list with integrated cross-curricular connections.

- Adding stated liturgical or worship components (even if non-denominational) to foreground liturgical practices more overtly.
- Providing more detailed faculty profiles showing teacher formation aligned with classical pedagogy and mentorship roles.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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